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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1950-1955

Coverage Date: Ca. 1950-1955

Place Coverage: !Kung San, Nyae Nyae Region, Namibia

Section Title(S): The Joking Relationship

The following table gives the joking status of each term.

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Material Not Relevant

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Kinship Terminology

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Kin Relationships

Consanguineous kin
Affines

Ego's generation and alternate generations					
<i>Joking permitted</i>					
(Ego)					
Anyone termed:	/gu/na tun/ga tūn	w.s.	Hu Wi DaHuFa SoWiFa DaHuMo SoWiMo	/hoa tsau /umba /undai	
			Anyone termed:	/gu/na-/umba tun/ga-/umba tūn-/undai	w.s.
Generations adjacent to ego's					
<i>Joking prohibited</i>					
Fa	ba		HuFa WiFa DaHu HuMo WiMo	≠tum /utsu	
Mo	dai				
So	/ha				
Da	≠khai				
Anyone termed:	tsu		Anyone termed:	tsu-/umba //ga-/undai	
	//ga di/guma				
Ego's siblings of same sex as ego, ego's spouse's siblings of same sex as spouse, and the spouses of these siblings					
<i>Joking permitted</i>					
Elder Br	/go	m.s.	BrWi WiSi	tūn	m.s.
Younger Br	tsi	m.s.			
Elder Si	/kwi	w.s.	SiHu HuBr	tun/ga	w.s.
Younger Si	tsi	w.s.			
Anyone termed:	/go	m.s.	WiSiHu	/go	m.s.
	/kwi	w.s.	HuBrWi	/kwi	w.s.
Any male termed:	tsi	m.s.			
Any female termed:	tsi	w.s.			
Ego's siblings of opposite sex, ego's spouse's siblings of opposite sex from spouse, and the spouses of these siblings					
<i>Joking prohibited</i>					
Elder Br	/go	w.s.	BrWi HuSi	/utsu	w.s.
Younger Br	tsi	w.s.			
Elder Si	/kwi	m.s.	SiHu WiBr	tun/ga	m.s.
Younger Si	tsi	m.s.			
Anyone termed:	/go	w.s.	HuSiHu	≠tum	w.s.
	/kwi	m.s.	WiBrWi	/utsu	m.s.
Any female termed:	tsi	m.s.			
Any male termed:	tsi	w.s.			

The jokes which are permitted among persons who have the joking relationship, and which are avoided by others, are sexual jokes and insults. Anyone may make jokes that are not sexually tinged. Persons who have the joking relationship constantly use it and enjoy it. Men accuse each other of excessive preoccupation with sexual intercourse or of having genital organs of excessive size or abnormal condition (castration or circumcision). Men accuse women with whom they may joke of being 22 ugly, slovenly, or wanton. The women retaliate, perhaps accusing the men of being worthy only of castration or of unfaithful wives. We noticed that the !Kung do not call each other sons of bitches. They are not concerned with lineage.

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Kin Relationships

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